

2.3.2 Number of Conditions

IF پروسیسر سے True/False پوچھتی ہے اس لیے زیادہ شاخیں کارکردگی گھٹاتی ہیں۔

CS XII

Chapter 2: Computational Thinking & Algorithms

Lecture 10 of 24

2.3.2 Number of Conditions

LEARN IT

Conditions (IF statements) are decision points. Every condition forces the CPU to evaluate True or False, so excessive branching reduces performance.

- **Computational cost.** Each IF is extra work, even if the rest of the algorithm is simple.
- **Nested conditions.** IF inside IF often means a brute-force approach. It hurts both readability and speed.
- **Short-circuiting** (the optimisation goal). Stop evaluating as soon as the result is known. In a logical AND, if the first part is False the second part is skipped. In a logical OR, if the first part is True the second part is skipped.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked example: cheap test first. You only divide if the denominator is not zero. Place the cheap, safe test on the left so Python never evaluates the dangerous part.

```
x = 0
y = 10
if x != 0 and (y / x) > 2:
    print("ratio is large")
else:
    print("skipped safely")
```

OUTPUT

skipped safely

$x \neq 0$ is False, so AND short-circuits and y / x is never attempted. If you wrote the division first, the program would crash. Same idea in the soldier algorithm: a False height test skips Step 6.

REMEMBER IT

Put the **cheapest / most likely False** test first in an AND, and the **most likely True** test first in an OR. That is short-circuiting used on purpose.

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: writing a chain of nested IFs when one compound condition would do (as in the velocity example in 2.2.2).

Fix: flatten with AND/OR, and rely on short-circuiting instead of extra layers.

اردو میں سمجھیں

IF پروسیسر سے True/False پوچھتی ہے اس لیے زیادہ شاخیں کارکردگی گھٹاتی ہیں۔ اندرونی IF اکثر brute-force ہوتی ہے۔ شارٹ سرکٹ (Short-circuit) کا مطلب ہے جیسے ہی جواب معلوم ہو جانچ روک دی جائے، مثلاً AND میں پہلی شرط False ہو تو دوسری نہ چلے۔

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Why do extra IF statements reduce performance?
2. What does nested IF often indicate?
3. In $x \neq 0$ and $(y / x) > 2$ with $x = 0$, why is there no division-by-zero?

Answers: 1. Each condition must be evaluated True/False by the CPU. 2. A brute-force approach (and it reduces readability and speed). 3. AND short-circuits: the first part is False, so the division is never evaluated.

Next lecture: 2.3.3 Number of Repetitions